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TABLE II
Sensor-Based Development Kits by Different Manufacturers

Development Kit	Types of sensors used	Description	Price
SI7005EVB-UDP-F960	Humidity Temperature	Combines ultra low power controller kit (C8051F960-A-DK) and humidity sensor daughter card (SI7005EVB-UDP) with data logger demonstration code	\$158.31
CC2541 SensorTag	IR temperature sensor Humidity sensor Pressure sensor Accelerometer Gyroscope Magnetometer	The first and only Bluetooth smart development kit focused on wireless sensor applications targeted for smart phone app developers	\$ 25
Freescale Xtrinsic FXOS8700CQ	6-axis Accelerometer 6-axis Magnetometer	It comprises 6-axis sensor PCB and 2 adaptor PCBs to enable communication with a PC over USB	\$99
JMBADGE2008	Ambient-light sensor 3D accelerometer Dual-touch strips	A low-cost development board that allows you to design with multiple solutions on a single board.	\$30
Shimmer Platinum Development Kit	Accelerometer Gyro Magnetometer ECG EMG GSR Strain gauge GPS Temperature sensor Barometric pressure sensor	It provides a comprehensive tool set to support rapid design, prototyping and implementation of wireless solutions based on the state-of-the-art Shimmer platform	€ 2749

web-connected sensors. This would also provide sensor systems that can be accessed in an independent, interoperable platform and would provide a uniform way for use in remote sensing, disaster management, public safety, environment monitoring and many other different applications.

3. SENSUSS came up with S3, which is a wireless helmet-mounted impact logger for car and bike racing drivers. It transmits data to the Eurotech Everyware Cloud so that it can be used to provide instant information on the level of the impact that an athlete experiences, in case of a crash, to the coaches, parents and even to the doctors.

4. Raytheon's Space and Airborne Systems that builds radars and other sensors for aircraft, ships and spacecraft is in a contract with ISRO to modernise the Indian air navigation system.

5. Autronics India has come up with CNE series sensor connectors that increase productivity by decreasing work-force and work time by 50 per cent.

Select with care

Sensor selection is very important for a design engineer, and we hope this article would help you select the right one. Priya, explains, "Most products that are user based are supposed to be started with the end-effector in mind. However, real-life situations are supposed to be considered whilst picking a sensor." Priya goes on to share a recent problem which her team went on to solve, "A recent project had us using a simple IR to control lights for a dance choreography piece, but at the last minute it started misbehaving at the big stage. That gave us a very important wireless design lesson—always have a hard switch too installed in the product just in case wireless fails. We did save the day by re-doing the circuit that night!" ●

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